

Drew McFarland

Senior Product Designer | USAF Veteran | Active Secret Clearance

work.velveteen.sh | drewjmcfarland@live.com

Experience

Rise8, Inc.

Senior Product Designer / Product Lead (May 2025 to Present)

- Ran discovery to identify the constraint blocking new tenant deployments on a government DevSecOps platform that replaces a 12- to 18-month accreditation process, then redirected the roadmap toward the capabilities new programs need first
- Led the redesign of tenant onboarding from provisioning through first deployment, facilitating service-blueprinting sessions with engineers and compliance leads and proposing reusable artifacts to reduce the high-touch engineering support new teams needed
- Shaped the productization plan around four measurable outcomes: environment standup, time to first deploy, developer-led delivery, and reusable compliance, giving leadership one framework for prioritizing and reporting progress

USAF | Kessel Run

Design Operations Lead (Apr 2022 to May 2025)

- Grew daily active users 300% for a flight-scheduling application by mapping the full service experience and working with military leadership to clear the operational roadblocks holding it back
- Used service blueprints to align 8 delivery teams around operator needs, keeping engineering focused on work operators needed instead of features nobody asked for
- Built Section 508 accessibility standards, research templates, and design playbooks adopted across 5 programs and still in use after I moved on

Product Designer (May 2017 to Apr 2022)

- Led UX for a pilot debriefing app used across multiple airframes and branches, from field research with aircrews through usability testing and delivery, cutting maintenance initiation time 20%
- Mapped developer journeys on a Platform-as-a-Service, surfaced 5 friction points, and drove changes that increased platform adoption roughly 40%
- Grew the app's footprint from 2 commands to 6 by finding advocates in each unit and running hands-on workshops to demonstrate fit before rollout

DrewUX

Service Design Consultant (Jun 2016 to Present)

- Took a defense technology startup from concept to launch by running user research, building service blueprints, and shaping the pitch that secured a New York City government contract and an SBIR grant
 - Led discovery for a DoD data-analysis startup and turned the research into a value story that contributed to a \$150K Phase I SBIR award
-

Education

M.S. Human-Computer Interaction, Iowa State University

B.S. IT Project Management, Western Governors University